

Chapter 13 – Troubleshooting and Common Issues

13.1 Introduction

During TIN registration and the use of IRD e-Services, taxpayers may experience various issues related to registration, login, PIN management, tax registration updates, or profile maintenance. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) provides procedures to resolve these issues through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.

This chapter outlines the most common problems faced by taxpayers and the recommended actions based on the official IRD guidance.

13.2 TIN Registration Issues

Problem: Registration Application is Rejected

A TIN registration application may be rejected if:

- Required information is incomplete.
- Mandatory fields are left blank.
- Supporting documents are missing.
- Uploaded documents are unclear or unreadable.
- Information provided does not match official records.

Solution

- Review the application carefully.
 - Correct any incorrect information.
 - Upload clear supporting documents.
 - Resubmit the application if required.
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Problem: Supporting Documents Cannot Be Uploaded

Possible causes include:

- Unsupported document format.
- Corrupted file.
- Poor-quality scanned document.
- Incorrect document category selected.

Solution

- Scan documents clearly.
 - Upload the correct document type.
 - Ensure files are complete and readable before submission.
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13.3 PIN Issues

Problem: PIN Mailer Not Received

After requesting a PIN online, the PIN Mailer is sent to the taxpayer's registered postal address.

If it is not received within approximately **two weeks**, taxpayers should visit the nearest Inland Revenue Department office.

Problem: Forgot PIN

If the current PIN is forgotten:

- Submit a new PIN request through the IRD e-Services Portal, or
- Visit the nearest IRD office.

A new PIN will be issued, and all previous PINs will become invalid.

Problem: Old PIN Does Not Work

Every new PIN request automatically invalidates all previously issued PINs.

Solution

Use only the latest PIN issued by the Inland Revenue Department.

13.4 Login Issues

Problem: Cannot Log In

Possible reasons include:

- Incorrect TIN.
- Incorrect PIN.
- Incorrect CAPTCHA.
- Locked account.
- Browser issues.

Solution

- Verify the TIN.
 - Verify the PIN.
 - Enter the CAPTCHA correctly.
 - Clear the browser cache.
 - Close all browser windows.
 - Use only one browser tab.
 - Use a supported browser.
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Problem: Account Locked

The IRD e-Services Portal automatically locks an account after **five consecutive incorrect login attempts**.

Solution

- Stop further login attempts.
 - Request a new PIN if necessary.
 - Visit an IRD office if assistance is required.
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13.5 Updating Profile Issues

Problem: Personal Details Cannot Be Updated

Possible reasons include:

- Missing supporting documents.

- Incorrect document type selected.
- Incomplete declaration.

Solution

- Upload the required supporting documents.
 - Complete the declaration.
 - Review the summary before submitting the request.
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Problem: Address Change Not Accepted

Possible causes include:

- No proof of address provided.
- Incorrect address details.
- Supporting document does not match the new address.

Solution

Submit valid proof of address such as:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Grama Niladhari Certificate

Ensure the information matches the application.

13.6 Tax Registration Issues

Problem: Unable to Update Tax Registration

Possible reasons include:

- Incorrect tax type selected.
- Missing supporting documents.
- Incomplete project information (for VAT).

Solution

- Select the correct registered tax type.
 - Upload all required supporting documents.
 - Review the application before submission.
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13.7 SSID Issues

Problem: Staff Cannot Access Company Tax Records

Possible reasons include:

- SSID has not been activated.
- Employee has not been authorized.
- Authorization period has expired.

Solution

- Activate the SSID.
 - Create a Staff Authorization.
 - Renew or recreate the authorization if necessary.
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Problem: Forgotten SSID Password

SSID passwords are managed by the company or registered tax agent.

Solution

Reset the password through the IRD e-Services Portal. The IRD does not reset SSID passwords on behalf of companies.

13.8 Tax Agent Issues

Problem: Tax Agent Cannot Access Client Information

Possible reasons include:

- The taxpayer has not authorized the tax agent.

- Incorrect Tax Agent TIN entered.
- Authorization has expired.

Solution

- Complete the Tax Agent Authorization process.
 - Verify the Tax Agent's TIN.
 - Create a new authorization if necessary.
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13.9 Browser and Technical Issues

Technical issues may occur due to browser settings.

Common solutions include:

- Clear browser cache.
 - Close all browser windows.
 - Open a new browser session.
 - Use only one browser tab.
 - Use a supported browser version.
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13.10 When to Contact the Inland Revenue Department

Taxpayers should contact the IRD if:

- The TIN registration cannot be completed.
- The PIN Mailer is not received within the expected period.
- Registration details cannot be updated.
- Tax registration requests are repeatedly rejected.
- Technical problems cannot be resolved using the recommended troubleshooting steps.

The **Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)** and the IRD Call Centre are available to assist taxpayers with registration, PIN requests, taxpayer profile updates, and other tax-related services.

13.11 Frequently Asked Questions

I forgot my PIN. What should I do?

Request a new PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal or visit an IRD office. All previous PINs become invalid after a new PIN is issued.

My account is locked. Can I unlock it myself?

If your account is locked after five incorrect login attempts, follow the IRD procedure to obtain a new PIN or seek assistance from the IRD.

I uploaded the wrong document. Can I replace it?

Yes. Before submission, uploaded documents can be removed and replaced with the correct documents through the e-Services Portal.

Why can't my employee log in using the SSID?

Ensure the SSID has been activated, the password has been changed after first login, and the employee has been properly authorized by the company.

13.12 Key Points

- Most registration and login issues can be resolved by reviewing application details, updating documents, or following the IRD recovery procedures.
- PIN-related issues are among the most common and usually require requesting a new PIN if the existing one cannot be used.
- Companies must manage SSID passwords and staff authorizations through the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Browser-related issues can often be resolved by clearing the cache, using a supported browser, and avoiding multiple browser tabs.
- If issues cannot be resolved through the e-Services Portal, taxpayers should contact the Inland Revenue Department for further assistance.